

● DINARA MUKHTAROVA

Project manager, game designer, and digital media developer focused on leading cross-disciplinary teams, building production pipelines, and creating polished interactive experiences across games, UX/UI, web, and visual design.

- ✦ Orlando, FL
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EDUCATION

M.S. Interactive Entertainment 2025 - 2026
Project Management - University of Central Florida, FIEA

B.A. Digital Arts and Sciences 2021 - 2025
Computer Science Minor - University of Florida

Summer Study Abroad 2023
Game Design - Kyoto University

RESEARCH

Live Service Games in Mobile Market 2026
Independent Research
Researched live service mechanics, player criticism, and long-term success trends in the mobile games industry.

Monetization in Sports Video Games 2025
Independent Research
Researched monetization systems in sports games, including Ultimate Team, MyTeam, virtual currencies, and loot-style reward systems.

LANGUAGES

- ✦ English / Russian - Fluent
- ✦ French / Azeri - Basics

AWARDS

- ✦ 1st Place - FIEA Game Jam
- ✦ DW Convergence Award

EXPERIENCE

Project Lead 2025 - Present
Wanderlust Studios - 24-member cross-disciplinary team

- ✦ Enforced a clear creative and production vision to improve team efficiency and decision making.
- ✦ Built and maintained a production schedule that kept the team on track and improved time usage.
- ✦ Recruited, interviewed, and onboarded contractors, then supported and managed them as part of the team.
- ✦ Connected Excel with Jira to create a front-end task system and streamline task tracking.
- ✦ Worked on game design and content implementation in Unreal Engine.
- ✦ Redesigned a level from scratch after a major scope change, defining narrative beats, player progression, and story timeline.

Backstage Operations 2023 - 2025
Phillips Center for the Performing Arts

- ✦ Used Shiftboard for team scheduling and time tracking.
- ✦ Managed merchandise sales and event-support responsibilities.
- ✦ Coordinated people, space, and resources while keeping operations functional during high-stress moments.

Creative Lead / Game Designer 2024 - 2025
Wisp Game Design Project

- ✦ Created the narrative, world concept, and creative vision for the project.
- ✦ Translated a story-driven concept into level design through pacing, layout, and environmental storytelling.
- ✦ Led the team around a clear creative vision and aligned design decisions throughout development.
- ✦ Designed and implemented core gameplay and level design systems.
- ✦ Created and maintained design documentation and feature specs.

Web & Graphic Designer 2019 - 2021
AT&S

- ✦ Redesigned the company website using Wix, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.
- ✦ Created logos and graphics for clients using Illustrator, Photoshop, and Procreate.
- ✦ Maintained the company core brand values and visual design standards.